

The Cinderwake Trilogy

One-Page Screen Rights Overview

Author: Alinari Campbell

Publisher/imprint: PixelPacific Publishing

Genre: Epic fantasy / adventure / found-family fantasy

Source status: Three completed novels, full trilogy arc complete

Screen format: Premium serialized television; animated limited series also viable

Logline

An expendable ash-runner from a poisoned mining city discovers she can hear the buried hearts of dead dragons and becomes the only witness who can stop kings, saints, and ancient grief from turning the living world into an obedient afterlife.

The Hook

Mara Venn is not a secret royal, chosen bloodline, or inherited savior. She is a poor worker hired to crawl through lethal cinder vents because powerful people consider her replaceable.

Then the stone under the mines speaks her name.

Across Vael Taryn, rulers have built cities, armies, wards, healing, and resurrection on cinders: the buried memory-organs of ancient dragons. Those cinders are waking. The dead are remembering. The surviving dragons are returning. Every faction wants Mara to become its weapon, saint, symbol, or proof.

Mara wins by doing the one thing power never expected from someone it treated as disposable: she listens, remembers, and refuses to spend other people to save herself.

Adaptation Shape

Season 1 / The Ash Beneath the Crown

Mara exposes the undead foundry beneath the crown and saves the mining city that once spent her life cheaply.

Season 2 / The Moon Below the World

Mara becomes a dangerous symbol as elven courts, rebel armies, engineers, and buried dragon memory collide beneath the world.

Season 3 / The Dragon That Dreamed Death

The dead rise in daylight, dragons return as judges, and Mara must reject both rule and martyrdom to break the covenant that made crowns stronger than people.

Why It Works On Screen

- Clear emotional engine: a powerless girl learning to hold power without becoming cruel.
- Strong ensemble: companions with tactical roles, secrets, cultural conflicts, and real affection.
- Visual mythology: dead dragon hearts under cities, haunted roads, underworld courts, memory engines, waking dragons, and a world powered by erased history.
- Built-in escalation: local survival story to continental faction war to mythic reckoning.
- Completed source spine: three finished novels plus series bible, outlines, cover art, and adaptation materials.

Audience Promise

For viewers who want large-scale fantasy with an intimate human center: found family, rebellion, ancient magic with a cost, dragons as moral memory, and a heroine who saves the world by refusing to treat anyone as expendable.

Available On Request

Full manuscripts, series bible, book-by-book outlines, cover art, audiobook samples, longer adaptation pitch, and season-by-season treatment materials.